

trying to create a podcast, a dancer trying to create the perfect track or a DJ looking to polish a set, Audacity is the perfect fit. The best thing about Audacity is its flexibility – the editing tools are compatible with almost any of the formats used for uploading or recording including MP3, OGG, WAV, AIFF etc. You can record, cut, copy, splice, add effects and change speed with extreme ease. However, Audacity does fall short in comparison to proprietary software in terms of its effects, instruments and plug-ins. Let's have a look at how it fares against our pick from among the proprietary software – Adobe Audition.

Pros

- ◆ The biggest advantage of Audacity is that it isn't expensive compared to Audition CC, which costs about ₹2,700 per month.
- ◆ For free software, you don't lose out on quality at all. The quality of the output is just as good as the quality on Audition.
- ◆ Fraunhofer's encoder used in Audition fails to save the correct time of the output files in VBR MP3 files, which LAME (the encoder than Audacity uses) does a much better job of.

Cons

- ◆ Effects are applied directly to the recording, meaning if you later decide to remove a particular effect, you'll need to remove everything you did up until that effect. Audition has an effect rack where you can easily turn them on or off without affecting the original files.
- ◆ Originals are not saved. After clicking save, there's no way to revert to the original file. Audition however saves originals so that you can go back to them at any point in time.
- ◆ Multi-track recording in Audition is much more superior than in Audacity.
- ◆ Audacity allows only a preview of the file before you can apply multi-band compression. It also has only a few presets for the multi-band compressor. Audacity, on the other hand, has multiple presets for a different number of instruments, and it allows you to preview the entire audio file before applying the compression.

You'd assume that Audition would beat Audacity purely based on its number of features. However, it's pretty commendable that Audacity can do most normal tasks such as recording, cutting, splicing, mixing etc. with ease and produce output comparable to Audition's in terms of quality. 